



Silicon Power's Touch T02

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DSL R Test

The contrast was also better in the images from the D800E as compared to the 5D MarkIII, but not by a whole lot. The dynamic range was visibly much higher on the D800E, with a tendency to be more partial towards the shadows while the 5D MarkIII seemed more favorable towards the highlights. It seems that the 5D MarkIII has a tendency for slightly 'cooler' white balance while the Nikon leans towards warmer tones. While each of these can be fixed in several, non-time-consuming ways, these color tones are suited for special purposes. For example, the Nikon, with its warmer tones will be more suited for weddings and portraiture, whereas the cooler tones of the Canon makes it a great camera for studio work. Color tones aren't everything though, as the amount of detail each sensor can resolve also matters. The D800E, with a neutralized anti-aliasing filter along with the high pixel count is able to capture a very large amount of detail, in good sharpness. However, it also suffers from the fact that even the slightest of shake, or even a touch of bad focus will show on the image. Unfortunately, that's the price we pay for great quality, that it amplifies even the slightest of mistakes. Therefore, the D800E is best suited for studio use, where it would be mostly mounted on a tripod.

The 5D MarkIII on the other hand, does capture extremely detailed images, without a tendency to show the flaws as blatantly as the D800E. It is far more forgiving. Not to mention, with an amped up AF system and a higher fps, it can also double up as a casual sports camera.

When examining our studio shots, we noticed that both the cameras deliver excellent image quality up to ISO 1600, but at ISO 3200, the Nikon shows some chroma noise while the Canon shows just hints of some luminance noise, though nothing too bad. At ISO 6400 however, the Canon maintains its hold on the noise, but the D800E produces images rife with both chroma and luminance noise. The native ISO on the D800E is 6400, while the 5D MarkIII goes all the way up to 25600, and produces useable images even at ISO 12800. Some would consider that ISO 25600 files as useable as well, with a little post processing and noise reduction, but it's not to our taste.

The video on these two cameras is equally important as the imaging. The 5D MarkII had become pretty much the industry standard for DSLR filming while the D700, its competitor lacked any video capabilities. The 5D MarkIII doesn't have many video improvements, but does render clean footage



Nikon D7000

at ISOs as high as 6400. The D800E is no less either. Video from the D800E is tack sharp (provided the focus is accurate) and quite vibrant. While the 5D MarkIII provides a maximum 1080p recording resolution, the D800E is capable of offloading uncompressed footage (4:2:2 color sampling) onto an external recorder via the HDMI port. The 1080p footage from both these cameras is almost indistinguishable, save for the warm color tones of the D800E and the cooler tone of the 5D MarkIII.

Verdict

While both the cameras are excellent performers, the **Canon**

5D MarkIII wins our **Best Performer** award due to its better ISO performance, slightly better video dynamic range and excellent ergonomics. It's a camera that you can carry around all day and not feel tired, something we cannot say for the D800E. Did we mention the 5D MarkIII has an insanely amazing focusing system? However, to be clear, the D800E is no less of a performer. Comparing the two is like comparing a Ferrari to a Lamborghini, where one will beat the other, but that doesn't mean the latter is bad. D800E is far cheaper than the 5D MarkIII and an excellent choice if you're looking to go full frame. **T**

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